The Teen Inflation Index: How To Spend Accordingly

Purpose:

1. What I am building is an inflation tracker for teenagers especially with teenagers spending money on things such as clothing, everyday food, movie tickets, birthday gifts, and my goal is to calculate how much the value of a dollar has shrunk specifically for high school students over the last year
2. This helps me understand data/economics because I am both using data from this year and last year and comparing the significant difference in money and dollar value which helps me not only make me interested in data science and economics but I would also learn more deeper into these 2 subjects combined!
3. I think young adocslents epecially us teengers in high school or in college who work in jobs but also want to have fun can really learn and benefit from this, as everytime adults always get helped by this, but teenagers usually don't really think about this much about inflation and it may even make them broke too!

Data Estimations

- **Trendy Clothing**(e.g branded hoodie)(basline estimation)(trendy clothing brands): 2026 $83 2025 $67
- **Food / Everyday Necessities** (e.g., a fast-food meal/boba)(average in USA)(using source:

https://worldpopulationreview.com/state-rankings/fast-food-prices-by-state): 2026 Price: $14.04 | 2025 Price: $11.36(basline estimate)

- **Movie Tickets** (a single ticket at a local theater): 2026 Price: $$17| 2025 Price: $16.08(basline estimate for 2026) and source for 2025(https://www.cinemark.com/movie-news/articles/movie-ticket-prices-guide)
- **Birthday Gifts** (a nice gift for a friend): 2026 Price: $30 | 2025 Price: $25(from gifts i have brought for my friends nice gifts)(basline estimate)
- **School Field Trips** (average cost for a club/class trip): 2026 Price: $120 | 2025 Price: $91 (from the field trips papers where they put the cost)(baseline estimation)

Pseudocode

1. Create a list of 5 target brands for trendy clothing[Nike, American Eagle, H&M, Adidas, Lululemon, Zara]
2. Create a list for their 2025 prices and a list for their 2026 prices
3. Repeat this step for Fast Food brands[Subway, Starbucks, Chipotle, Taco Bell, McDonald's]
4. Create a list for their 2025 prices and a list for their 2026 prices
Repear this step for Movie Theater Chains[AMC, Regal, Cinemark, Cinepolis, and Alamo Drafthouse]
5. Create a list for their 2025 prices and a list for their 2026 prices
6. Repeat this step for Gift Retailers/Items[Art, Skincare, Makeup, Toys, Decorative Objects]
7. Create a list for their 2025 prices and a list for their 2026 prices

8. Create a formula: Inflation Rate = (2026 Average - 2025 Average)/(2025 Average) x 100
*Average: (Adding Items then dividing)
9. Ask if the user has a job?
10. If the user says yes then ask what is your weekly income, else (no job) say got it understood
11. Ask the user two questions: "Approximately how much do you spend each week?" and "What category do you spend the most money on?"
12. Then calculate purchase loss by Multiply weekly spending by the overall inflation rate divided by 100.
13. Then Match Inputted Category: Look at what the user typed to find their specific category inflation rate.
14. Display the overall calculated teen inflation rate, weekly extra cash lost, and their favorite category's specific inflation rate.
15. COMPARE user inflation rate to the overall average:

- IF user rate is LESS than overall average:
    - OUTPUT: "You are doing very well! You are not like the rest of the average teen girls."
- ELSE IF user rate is EQUAL TO overall average:
    - OUTPUT: "It's alright, at least it's not super high! However, consider cutting down spending on your category and go for Movie Theaters instead since its value is much better."
- ELSE IF user rate is HIGHER than overall average:
    - OUTPUT: "I highly suggest you cut down spending on your category and spend more on Movie Theaters since its value is much better!"

Coding

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# Trendy Clothing category

clothing_brands = ["Nike", "American Eagle", "H&M", "Adidas", "Zara",
"Lululemon"]

clothing_prices_2025 = [22.50,20.98,14.99,78,47.94,64]

clothing_prices_2026 = [75,58.45,22.99,80,39.6,88]

clothing_average_2025 = (sum(clothing_prices_2025)/6)
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clothing_average_2026 = (sum(clothing_prices_2026)/6)

clothing_inflation_rate = (((clothing_average_2026 -
clothing_average_2025)/clothing_average_2025)*100)

# Fast Food brands category

Fast_foods = ["Subway", "Starbucks", "Chipotle", "Taco Bell", "McDonald"]

Fast_food_price_2025 = [8.49,3.05,11.35,1.39,10.69]

Fast_food_price_2026 = [11.39,3.75,10.80,1.29,12.59]

fast_food_average_2025 = (sum(Fast_food_price_2025)/5)

fast_food_average_2026 = (sum(Fast_food_price_2026)/5)

fast_food_inflation_rate = (((fast_food_average_2026 -
fast_food_average_2025)/fast_food_average_2025)*100)

# Movie Theater Chains category

Movie_Theater_Chains = ["AMC", "Regal", "Cinemark", "Cinepolis", "Alamo
Drafthouse"]

Movie_Theater_Chains_price_2025 = [25,15.75,16.08,19,14.25]

Movie_Theater_Chains_price_2026 = [18,16.08,14.5,17,14.88]

Movie_theater_average_2025 = (sum(Movie_Theater_Chains_price_2025)/5)

Movie_theater_average_2026 = (sum(Movie_Theater_Chains_price_2026)/5)

Movie_theater_inflation_rate = (((Movie_theater_average_2026 -
Movie_theater_average_2025)/Movie_theater_average_2025)*100)

# Gifts_choosing category

Gift_Items = ["Art", "Skincare", "Makeup", "Toys", "Decorative Objects"]
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Gift_Items_price_2025 = [24,36,49,23.45,45.64]

Gift_Items_price_2026 = [32,45,60,34.56,43.23]

gift_items_average_2025 = (sum(Gift_Items_price_2025)/5)

gift_items_average_2026 = (sum(Gift_Items_price_2026)/5)

gift_items_inflation_rate = (((gift_items_average_2026 -
gift_items_average_2025)/gift_items_average_2025)*100)

# Streaming category

Streaming = ["Spotify", "Apple TV", "Youtube", "Netflix", "HBO Max"]

Streaming_prices_2025 = [11.99,12.99,13.99,17.99,18.49]

Streaming_prices_2026 = [12.99,12.99,15.99,19.99,18.49]

Streaming_average_2025 = (sum(Streaming_prices_2025)/5)

Streaming_average_2026 = (sum(Streaming_prices_2026)/5)

Streaming_inflation_rate = (((Streaming_average_2026 -
Streaming_average_2025)/Streaming_average_2025)*100)

# Overall Teen Inflation Rate

overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate = (((clothing_inflation_rate +
fast_food_inflation_rate + Movie_theater_inflation_rate +
gift_items_inflation_rate + Streaming_inflation_rate )/5))

# Interactive Persona Quiz

ask_job = input("Do you have a job? (Yes or No): ")

if ask_job == "Yes" or ask_job == "yes":

 weekly_income = float(input("What is your weekly allowance or income? "))
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else:

 print("Understood. Thanks!")

# Next Questions

hours_needed = float(input("Approximately how much do you spend each week?
"))

money_category = input("What category(Trendy Clothing, Fast Foods, Movie
Theaters ,Gifts, and Streaming) do you spend the most money on? ")

purchasing_loss = hours_needed * (overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate /100)

# Specific Category Inflation Rate

user_category_rate = 0.0

if "trendy clothing" in money_category.lower() or "trendy clothing" in
money_category.lower() or "trendy clothing" in money_category.lower() or
"clothing" in money_category.lower() or "clothing" in
money_category.lower():
 user_category_rate = clothing_inflation_rate

elif "fast foods" in money_category.lower() or "fast foods" in
money_category.lower() or "fast foods" in money_category.lower() or
"foods" in money_category.lower() or "food" in money_category.lower():
 user_category_rate = fast_food_inflation_rate

elif "movie theaters" in money_category.lower() or "movie theaters" in
money_category.lower() or "movie theaters" in money_category.lower() or
"movie" in money_category.lower() or "movies" in money_category.lower():
 user_category_rate = Movie_theater_inflation_rate

elif "gifts" in money_category.lower() or "gifts" in
money_category.lower() or "gift" in money_category.lower() or "gift" in
money_category.lower():
 user_category_rate = gift_items_inflation_rate
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elif "streaming" in money_category.lower() or "streaming" in
money_category.lower() or "stream" in money_category.lower() or "stream"
in money_category.lower():
 user_category_rate = Streaming_inflation_rate

else:
 user_category_rate = overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate

# Final Report

print("----------- YOUR PERSONAL TEEN INFLATION REPORT -----------")

print(f"The overall teen inflation rate calculated is:
{overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:.2f}%")

print(f"Based on your weekly spending, inflation is costing you an extra
${purchasing_loss:.2f} per week.")

print(f"Your highest spending category is: {money_category} (Inflation
Rate: {user_category_rate:.2f}%)")

# User Inflation Rate less/equal/higher than overall inflation rate

if user_category_rate < overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:
 print(f"Your category inflation rate ({user_category_rate:.2f}%) is LESS
than the overall teen average of
{overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:.2f}%.")
 print("You are doing very good! You are not like rest of the average teen
girls")

elif user_category_rate == overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:
 print(f"Your category inflation rate ({user_category_rate:.2f}%) is EQUAL
TO the overall teen average of {overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:.2f}%.")
 print(f"It's alright, at least it's not super high! However, consider
cutting down spending on {money_category}")
 print(f"It's suggested to go for Movie Theater since its value is only
this: {Movie_theater_inflation_rate:.2f}% ")
 elif user_category_rate > overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:
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 print(f"Your category inflation rate ({user_category_rate:.2f}%) is 
HIGHER than the overall teen average of 
{overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:.2f}%.")
 print(f"I highly suggest you to cutdown spending on {money_category} and 
spend more on Movie Theater since its value is only 
this:{Movie_theater_inflation_rate:.2f}% ")

else:
 print(f"Your category inflation rate ({user_category_rate:.2f}%) is 
HIGHER than the overall teen average of 
{overall_teen_girls_inflation_rate:.2f}%!")
 print(f" Ouch! Your budget is getting hit hard. You should definitely cut 
down your spending on {money_category} a bit.")
 print(f"To lower your personal inflation impact, try hanging out at Movie 
Theaters ({Movie_theater_inflation_rate:.2f}%) or using Streaming 
platforms ({Streaming_inflation_rate:.2f}%) where prices are much safer!")
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